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to Bluetooth or WiFi. So Android Beam uses NFC and take advantage of its convenience in quick communication over short distances, and uses that to authenticate the devices so that that it can use quicker technologies for the actual transfer of data. As such it can transfer anything, music, videos, or the state of an application, such as tabs open in a browser, the saved state of a game etc.

NFC is also finding many uses in places where RFID was used earlier. For example it can be used as an alternative to ID cards.

One up and coming use is as a means of payment. Google Wallet for example allows one to initiate payments by simply tapping your phone on a payment device. Your financial details can be stored on Google Wallet, and when you initiate a transfer using NFC, Google Wallet only needs your authorisation for payment, and handles the rest.

Games can use NFC to initiate a multiplayer gaming session and use WiFi or Bluetooth for the actual game data.

Tapping mobile and tablets, or putting them in close proximity makes a lot of sense, but one is likely to have a hard time imagining such a thing working with desktops. Even so, a laptop or desktop fitted with NFC can use that functionality to enable all kinds of useful interactions. You could for example, transfer your browsing session to your tablet / mobile from your laptop / desktop before leaving home. Or sync between you laptop / desktop and mobile / tablet just by using NFC.

You won't find NFC on many laptops or desktops but it is only a matter of time. Look

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at how Bluetooth is now common on many laptops and you will see how it is likely to find future laptops fitted with NFC. Desktops usually have neither but are flexible enough to use dongles to add those capabilities.

There are tons of imaginative uses for NFC that people have yet to come up with. All one needs to know are the advantages

of NFC at your disposal, quick initiation of communication, moderately fast data transfer speeds (around 400 kbit/s) and the possibility of having passive (without battery) items that interact with NFC devices.

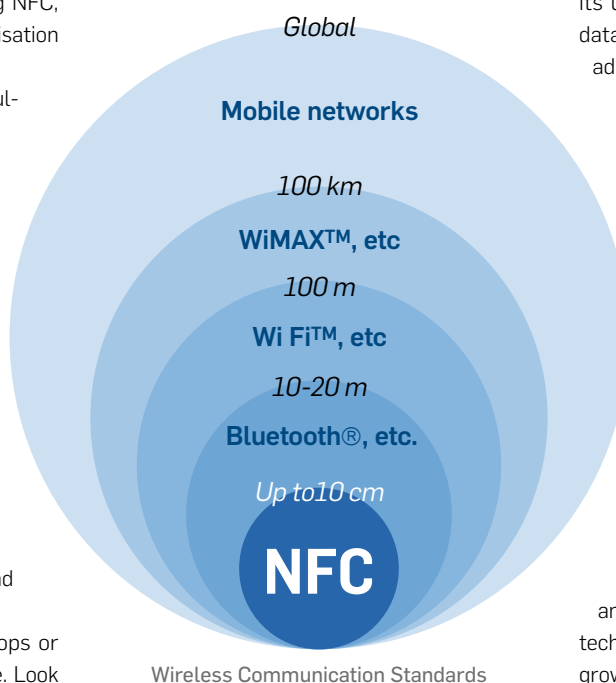
THE FUTURE OF NFC

NFC is growing, slowly. With each passing year more phones tout NFC capabilities and its uses as a means of payment or simple data exchange are growing. Across the world adoption of NFC is growing and it is being using in public transit systems, and banks.

Even in India it is in use by PayMate, an Indian mobile payment network, and Tata Docomo.

Nintendo's upcoming Wii U will support NFC in its gamepad allowing for new forms of gameplay and the possibility of NFC-driven microtransactions. Windows 8 and Windows 8 Phone both have extensive support for NFC and Intel aims to make the feature available on its Ultrabooks as well.

The future is bright for NFC technology, and this is the initial stage, where any innovation could come along and cause a sudden burst in adoption for the technology. Even otherwise it is on a positively growing trend is a technology to look out for.



Wireless Communication Standards